

AI GOVERNANCE

**The room feels
private.
The log does not.**

What you paste into AI can show up in discovery. Most people have no idea.

Here is the two-second habit that changes that.

Your chat history is a record. Not a private room.

- Employment disputes. Contract disagreements. Regulatory reviews.
- Legal teams on both sides now ask: what did you put into the AI, and when?
- Most platforms retain conversation history by default. That is not a bug. It is the product.

Retained history is useful. It is also a record.

WHAT THE LOG CONTAINS

Not just your output. Your reasoning.

- | Your drafts — the version before you cleaned it up
- | The client name you mentioned while framing the question
- | The decision you were working through before you made it
- | The conflict described in plain language before the official version

That is context around intent. That is what discovery looks for.

HABIT 1

**Decide before
you paste.
Not after.**

One question, two seconds

If this conversation were forwarded to the other side in a dispute,
would I care?

Not "is this secret." Just: would I care? That is the whole test.

HABIT 2

Redact the name. Keep the situation.

- "Client A" instead of the client's name
- "Operations director" instead of the employee's name
- "Fixed fee, disputed scope" instead of the contract number

The AI gives you the same answer. The log no longer holds the specific detail that matters.

HABIT 3

Know your retention setting. Actually check it.

Two different situations

History off by default and history on by default are not the same thing. Most people do not know which one they are in.

If your account is company-managed, your IT team set the retention policy. Not you.

THE PRE-PASTE RULE

Three questions. Two seconds each.

Does this contain identifying detail I would prefer not to surface?

Am I describing a decision or conflict that could become context around intent?

Do I know whether this platform is retaining this conversation?

This is the same reflex you already apply to email. You just haven't applied it here yet.

full/REFIT

Get the AI Paste-and-Retention checklist.

Three pre-paste questions, the substitution habit, and where to find the retention setting in the major tools. Two minutes to apply.

Get the free checklist

(Link in the first comment)